

OREGON CITY COURIER

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NATION IN RUIN: YET IS LIVING

BELGIUM'S PLIGHT FROM WAR
TOLD VIVIDLY IN REPORT
SENT GOVERNMENT

COUNTRY TRYING TO REVIVE

Manufacturers Keep Plants Running
in effort to Provide Employees
With Wages for Supplies

A partial story of what the great European war has done to Belgium, and of the havoc wrought by the German invasion of the busy kingdom, is told in the formal report of Consul General Watts, sent from Brussels to the United States government on May 31, and released for publication in Washington the last day of July. A copy of this report has been sent the Courier, and reveals the devastating effect of the German invasion of Belgium, and the subsequent efforts of the German invaders to in a measure rehabilitate the nation. It also shows the indomitable courage of the Belgians in the face of the disaster that overtook their country when Europe went war-mad, and reveals pathetically the efforts of Belgian businessmen and manufacturers to keep their enterprises operating, so that their employees would not suffer any more than could be avoided. The report covers the year 1914 and the early part of 1915. When the year opened business in Belgium was a trifle below normal, but prospects for a prosperous year in all lines were excellent. At the start of the year imports into Belgium showed an increase of 2.2 percent—hardly enough to notice particularly; while exports showed an increase over the preceding year of 5.7 percent—just enough gain to encourage manufacturers.

With the rise of the war cloud in Europe hopes of better business vanished, and with the advance of the Germans the bottom fell out of everything. While workers in many lines of industry quit their employment to rally to the defense of the little nation, a few machine shops and foundries continued working. After the German hordes had overrun the country a few firms were permitted by the conquerors to make special machinery for the manufacture of sugar and to export their products to America. To rebuild the structures ruined by artillery fire, the Germans gave the Belgians permission to manufacture a limited amount of iron and steel girders for home trade only. Near Brussels permission was given to manufacture railroad materials so that destroyed lines of communication might be replaced. On the whole the iron trade, in all its branches, at the end of May, was working on about one-sixth time.

The linen industry, which is an important one in Belgium, was in good shape until the war started. Then it came to a complete standstill. However, in order to make provision for the laboring classes, most of the mills and factories went on with their work as best they could. With all means of transportation destroyed or put to uses of war, but little could actually be accomplished, and the war finally brought the linen industry to such shape that but 24 hours work could be given to each employee in every five days. Just before the report of Consul General Watts was mailed, permission had been given to some of the linen mills to export a portion of their products, and this bettered conditions somewhat.

Owing to the limited amount of work to be had, linen workers have demanded an increase in wages, but even when this has been granted supplies have been so high in price that it was only with the greatest difficulty that workers could earn enough to answer their barest needs.

Fruits and vegetables still furnish a product to such as can grow them. They are bought by intermediaries, and are shipped at once to Germany, there to be used in provisioning the conquering people. No other export trade in foodstuffs is permitted. The wool industry has suffered perhaps the least of any, as Germans have paid good prices for all wool or woolen goods they could get. In the wool industry men receive about 75 cents a week, and children 40 cents a week, and in addition are given bread, soup and clothes. Thus has the war stricken the land of Belgium.

The businessmen and manufacturers of the stricken nation are carrying a heavy burden in caring for their employees and those dependent upon them. With practically no profits from their plants except those the Germans will permit, many of the manufacturers are spending from 40,000 to 45,000 francs a month to keep their workmen and their families from starvation.

Coal mining stopped abruptly with the German invasion, and subsequent to that only 60 percent of the miners returned to work under German supervision, and turned out only 30 percent of the normal product. Ger-

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NEW LAW MADE

Stealing Chickens isn't "Burglary;" Nor is it Safe

Recorder Loder, of the county seat, laid down a new principle of law this week when Ed Florey and John Druggier were brought to him for trial to explain how it happened that they had, in the dark of the moon, entered the chicken coop of Frank McGahey and abstracted therefrom two chickens, of the reasonable value of \$25. Patrolman George Woodward caught the men in the act of raiding the chicken coop, and arrested them as "burglars."

Burglary, or breaking and entering in the night-time with intent to steal, is a felony in Oregon, and is risky business anywhere. And Patrolman Woodward said that Florey and Druggier were burglars. When arraigned before Recorder Loder, the judge explained to the men—who were willing to plead guilty, that "burglary" was a serious charge, and that if they pleaded guilty to it he could do nothing but send them to the county jail to await action of the grand jury. This so increased the troubles of the pair that they asked Mr. Loder if he couldn't fix things up, as they were sure that they were not burglars. They had merely wanted the chicken to eat at a party, they protested, and didn't think that raiding a chicken coop was burglary.

Recorder Loder thought it over for awhile, and not wanting to see the men languish in jail for what had been largely a "lark" (even if it was a chicken, instead), finally reached a conclusion that establishes a new precedent in local legal circles.

"I will change this charge from burglary to one of just stealing chickens," said Recorder Loder. "I think this court will have jurisdiction over that. And since you plead guilty to stealing chickens, I will accept your plea, and will fine you twenty dollars."

And so it developed that chicken stealing is no longer burglary.

JOYS OF THE OFFICE

Neighborly Paper Tells Some Things That Make Journalism a Joy

The Aurora Observer last week revealed a few newspaper secrets. Lest people think the Observer is the only paper so afflicted, the Courier reprints its remarks with a hearty "Amen" at the end. Says the Observer:

"There is no doubt that it requires many kinds of people to make up a community, but the Observer is glad that it has no subscribers of the kind that wrote the following letter to the News-Journal, of Campbellville, Kentucky:

"Please send me a few copies of the paper containing the obituary of my aunt. Also publish the enclosed clipping of the marriage of my niece, who lives in Lebanon. And I wish you would mention in your local column if it does not cost anything, that I have two bull calves for sale. As my subscription is out, please stop my paper. Times are too bad to waste money on newspapers."

"It is often said that the world is full of people who want something for nothing, but investigation always shows that such people always live just outside our community—in the next county, the next town, the next county, or just across the mountains. That class of people are not our people—not our patrons, not our subscribers. They are subscribers and patrons of our friend the enemy—our competitors, and did we wish them ill, we would wish them more such patrons. But since we wish all men well, here's hoping each gets what he wants and what he deserves—and the wherewith to pay for it!"

The Courier for job printing.

GIRL IS DROWNED

Estacada Lass Meets Death While Trying to Save Friends

While bathing in Eagle Creek, near Estacada, Miss Ruth Githens, of Estacada, was drowned last week while trying to pull two of her companions from deep water. Girls on the bank threw a sapling to Miss Githens, but she was too weak to retain her hold upon it, and sank under the surface. The girls she was trying to fetch in to shore were saved.

Miss Githens was 16 years of age, and was one of the most popular pupils in the Estacada high school. Her parents, Mr. and Mrs. Henry Githens, of Estacada, are well known in the northern part of the county, and universal sympathy is extended to them in their bereavement.

HILL WORK KILLS

Cyclist Dies of Heart-Failure after "Pumping" up Grade

Eugene Hyland, of Arleta, tried to ride his bicycle up a hill near Clackamas last week. The hill had some characteristic Clackamas county road upon it, and when Hyland got to the top of the grade he dropped off his machine and expired.

The body was discovered by A. A. Durkee, who notified the coroner. Investigation showed that Hyland had died of heart-failure, induced by over-exertion. The dead man was about 50 years old, and was well known throughout Arleta and Lents.

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COUNCIL STARTS SEVERAL THINGS

MORE STREET PAVING; PLANS
FOR PURCHASE OF HIGH-
WAY PLANT TALKED

"THIRTEENTH" SESSION GAY

Old Question of Rock-crusher Bobs
up again under Leadership
of Mr. Templeton

Oregon City's "Friday-the-thirteenth" council meeting, and its aftermath—a special meeting Monday of this week—saw a number of things started by the city dads. The "aftermath" meeting came off Monday afternoon at five, and saw two ordinances for street improvement railroad through with a whiz—one providing for a six-inch improvement with asphaltic concrete of Tenth street, from the railroad track west, and one for a five-inch asphaltic concrete of Seventh street from the entrance to the public elevator to Main street. Final action on the improvement of these streets will come up at the regular meeting September first. Presumably the same firm that is now putting asphaltic concrete on Main street will get the jobs; though bids will be received in a formal way.

At Monday's meeting the city engineer also certified that Third street, street, has been properly improved, and machinery for the acceptance of motion.

To close Monday's session Councilman Meyer called the attention of the council to the fact that Mr. Brandt, the retiring sexton at the cemetery, had been occupying a house on city property during his term of office, and had planted some crops on the ground surrounding it. His unexpected defeat for reappointment makes it necessary for him to move, and Mr. Meyer thought it would be nice if the council would let him have until the first of the year to vacate his quarters and to harvest his crop.

Councilman Metzner thought well of the Meyer plan, and moved that the city adopt it. Councilman Hackett said he had no objection to Mr. Brandt having until the first of the year to harvest his crops, but thought that if occupancy of the house was one of the perquisites of the sexton's job, that Mr. Clark, the newly appointed sexton, ought to be considered.

Mayor Jones called attention to the fact that two members of the cemetery committee were absent, and suggested that the matter be held in abeyance until they could bring in a majority report on the question. The mayor said he didn't want to see any fireworks set off by action of the council when the majority of the cemetery committee was absent. Of the committee Mr. Metzner had voted for the reappointment of Mr. Brandt, and Messrs. Cox and Van-Auken had voted for his successor. The question was naturally delicate.

Mr. Hackett finally poured oil on the fast troubling waters by moving that Mr. Brandt be allowed till the end of the year to harvest his crops, and be allowed to occupy the house till the first of September, by which time the council would take further action.

The "Friday-the-thirteenth" session of the council, staged on the "unlucky day" last week, pretty well fulfilled expectations. The junk ordinance was pushed over after a lively fight, in which Councilman Albright repeated his previous ideas about it being a "company measure" and an unjust piece of legislation. The measure, defeated at previous sessions, was shoved through to victory by one lone and solitary vote.

The sum of \$150, to pay for a special operative main for the public elevator was passed on the thirteenth, though there was some opposition to the appropriation from those councilmen who occasionally have a warm regard for the mythical city budget. The \$3150 will be materialized from some of the mysterious recesses of the city, and it was promised that its production would not warp the budget as much as was expected. Part of the money will come out of the elevator fund, which through a system of high finance, still has something like \$1800 within its depths. This money is in the elevator fund because interest on the elevator bonds was paid out of the general fund.

Councilman Templeton took Friday the thirteenth as a date upon which to revive the purchase of "a city rock-crushing plant." The old Jones rock-crusher, leading character in the former battle for a municipal rock-crusher waged by ex-Councilman Toose, again became the subject of assorted remarks. Instead of paying \$5,000 or \$6,000 for the crusher, however, Mr. Templeton said he thought the city could now purchase it for something over \$2,000.

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SOFT STREET HINTED

City Engineer Says Worswick Paving will take Year to Harden

In an informal discussion of Main street's new paving before the Oregon City council Monday afternoon of this week, City Engineer Miller said that the Worswick pavement was going to make a fine highway, but that if next summer was one of the average number of warm days the pavement would be soft to quite a noticeable degree.

"It will make a good pavement, there is no question of that," said City Engineer Miller, "but asphaltum is a very soft substance, and my experience has been that it usually takes a year to 'season' and that if warm weather comes during the first twelve months that it is laid, it will yield under ordinary traffic, and will cut badly under heavy loads."

Members of the council present who had supported the adoption of the Worswick paving, disagreed with Mr. Miller, and said that they understood that the company was adding some hardening substance to its mixture.

"I know that," replied Mr. Miller. "They are adding amorphous lime, and to a degree this will harden the pavement. But I have observed that in all forms of asphaltic mixtures it takes about a year for the asphaltum to 'season,' and until it is seasoned it will not stand warm weather. Once the pavement has hardened it cannot be excelled. There is enough asphaltum in the mixture being laid on Main street, however, to make it soft for the first year, and it will be noticeably soft if we have warm weather next summer. I do not mean that it will rut, but it will be soft. And under heavy loads it will rut badly. At least, such is my opinion."

TIME FOR GOOD ROADS IS NEAR

COUNTY COURT PLANS CHANGE
IN METHODS OF CONSTRUCTION OF HIGHWAYS

JUDGE ANDERSON NOW IN LINE

Abrupt Change in Policy Swings far
to Other Extreme in Regard to
Surfacing Traffic Routes

Following the statement two weeks ago by Commissioner Mattson, to the effect that the county court was considering the abolishment of the supervisor system in highway maintenance, and that in all probability the county would be divided into four districts and each division placed in charge of a competent roadmaster; County Judge Anderson this week announced that as far as he was concerned there would be no more catch-as-catch-can road building in the county. With two members of the county court thus declaring themselves, and with every newspaper in the county and several outside of the county laughing at Clackamas roads, appearances are such as to lead people to believe that there will be a change for the better in local road conditions very shortly.

There is no doubt that the exposure of the squandering of road funds during the last year—made by Expert Richardson of the state insurance department, and widely reported in the press—has been the "last straw" that has broken the back of the county court's former adherence to the wasteful supervisor system. When it was widely advertised that Clackamas county had during 1914 spent \$368,214.85 on its roads, and that this sum (outside of bond issues) was the second largest outlay in the state for highways, people were so generally shocked that the county court must have heard about it. In 1914 Clackamas county spent nearly half as much as did Multnomah county on its roads—and at the end of the year had nothing to show for it.

County Judge Anderson strongly recommends bituminous macadam roads for all future trunk-highway work in the county. According to his ideas hard surface roads are too costly for the county to lay at present, but a two-inch dressing of crushed rock and bitumen will be found not only to be economical; but will also serve local road demands ideally. The best road in the county at the present time—the River road between Gladstone and the top of the Milwaukie hill—is of this form of construction; and though heavily traveled has stood up wonderfully year in and year out.

To make the county roads serviceable, County Judge Anderson would have the present macadam roads sacrificed and brought to grade, all potholes filled with rock and rolled, and then the two-inch dressing applied. If this is done Clackamas county will have roads the equal of the old Base Line road in Multnomah county, or the equal of the present River road when it was new. Estimates on this sort of roadway, made by Ed Olds,

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DANIELS PLANS FEDERAL PLANT

SECRETARY OF NAVY WOULD
SAVE ON PRICE OF
SHIP ARMOR

"WAR TRUST" IS COMBATTED

Congressman Tavenner Tells Courier
Readers how Administration is
Trying to Gain Economy

Congressman Clyde H. Tavenner, who is trying to bring about sensible reforms in the management of the United States navy, and who believes that the government's vessels should be of government workmanship throughout, has shed some interesting light upon the plans formulated by Secretary Daniels, of the Navy Department. Mr. Tavenner's remarks may also give to some an idea of the motives behind the attack upon Secretary Daniels—an attack that has been most noticeable in republican papers whose sympathies are notoriously with "big business." In discussing Secretary Daniels' plans, Mr. Tavenner says:

"When Mr. Daniels, for many years editor and publisher of the Raleigh (N. C.) News and Observer, was sworn in as Secretary of the Navy and had time to look about him, he found that the people's money was being wasted by the payment of excessive prices for armor and practically all articles required for the navy. Throughout his two years in the Cabinet he has been earnestly endeavoring to rescue the Public Treasury from the patriots for war, who year in and year out have been helping themselves, seemingly at will, from the public crib. Secretary Daniels has saved the Government some \$2,000,000, which is but a drop in the bucket to the amount he could save if he could obtain Government manufacture of everything."

In his first annual report for the year 1913 Secretary Daniels asked for an appropriation for an armor-plate factory, saying:

"I desire to recommend the passage at the earliest moment of a sufficient appropriation to begin the construction of a Government armor plant to relieve a situation which, in my estimation, is intolerable and at total variance with the principle of economy in spending Government money. * * * Only three firms in this country can manufacture armor plate, and these firms have put in bids for armor plate seldom varying over a few dollars, and in many instances being identical to a cent. Asked for reasons as to the uniformity of these bids, two of the firms replied frankly that as the contract would be divided amongst them anyway, the only effect of competitive bids would be to reduce the profits made by all of the three firms."

"By manufacturing armor plate in its own plant the Government will be able to keep for its own use any improvements in the manufacture or composition of its armor that may be developed. The last word has not been said in armor, and past history shows that great improvements in the manufacture and design of armor plate have been made. The greater part of these improvements were suggested by actual experience gained by naval officers. Under our present system of obtaining our armor plate from private companies such improvements become the property of all the world and can be obtained by anybody who cares to buy them. Even now the improvements in armor and the designs worked out by the Navy have been embodied in the warship of another nation recently finished by the Bethlehem Steel Co., and put into commission. This is not an arguable Government armor plant, nor has it been overlooked, for instance, by Japan, which has erected its own armor-making plant and surrounded it with such secrecy that none of the other nations are able to tell whether or not at this minute the Japanese armor may not be superior to any other in existence. In addition to Japan, the French government, after experimenting with a factory capable of producing only the lighter weights of armor, is enlarging its government plant so as to permit or the production of thick plates, and Russia has had its own armor-plate factory for some time."

"I do not see how it is possible for Congress to justify to the people a refusal to erect a government plant, nor how it can answer the charge that will be invariably be brought up—that the same mysterious Providence which saved this profitable business to the steel companies three times in the past, even after money for a government plant had actually been appropriated, is not still at work exercising its beneficent protection over these lusty specimens of infant industries, who are even now under government investigation as violators of the anti-trust law."

The Courier—the liveliest county paper. \$1 per year if paid in advance. Why not now, and get the news.

NOW SEE WHAT'S COME

Professional Prohibitionist Tears up
"Dry" Nest

Elsewhere in these columns the Courier prints a letter from George C. Brownell, one-time candidate for United States senator on a strictly "dry" platform—at least so Mr. Brownell said he was going to be—in which the statewide prohibition law enacted by the last session of the legislature is called "an insult to the people" and a few other things. Mr. Brownell pretends to be "all het up" over the act of the legislature in passing a law that will permit 24 quarts of hard booze to be purchased by any thirsty Oregonian once a month after the law goes into effect.

Mr. Brownell says that this was an outrage on the part of the legislature, inasmuch as the people voted for an amendment to the state constitution which was as follows:

"From and after January 1, 1916, no intoxicating liquor shall be manufactured or sold within this state, except for medicinal purposes upon prescription of a licensed physician, or for scientific, sacramental or medicinal purposes."

If the facts were as Mr. Brownell assumes them, the legislature might deserve all the sweet things he says about it. It might even be surmised that the legislature was influenced by "certain Portland people and interests," as he intimates.

However, there must be a suspicion that Mr. Brownell is seeking anew to get into the political limelight through his tirade against the prohibition law. Maybe Mr. Brownell is going to blossom out as a senatorial candidate on a "more-than-prohibition" platform. Maybe he is going to be so much of an "ultra-prohibitionist" that he will attack the present law, argue for its repeal, and so please the "wets."

As a matter of fact the people of Oregon knew full well what they were voting for when they voted for the so-called "prohibition law." Mr. Wheeler and his Committee of One Hundred, ably assisted by Orton Goodwin, their English press-agent, told the people in shrieking advertisements and in column after column of prepared boiler-plate, that the purpose of the proposed prohibition amendment was to do away with the open saloon. Eleventh hour advertising by the "drys" proclaimed only this: "Do not be fooled, the open saloon is the issue."

And the "wets" tickled to death at Mr. Wheeler's admission of the purposes of the Committee of One Hundred, went into all the papers of the state that they could reach, and in page and two-page advertisements shouted at the people that the proposed law was NOT prohibition, that it would permit the shipping into the state of a certain quantity of beer or booze every month, and that it would take from the state \$900,000 in annual revenue, and would send Oregon money to California liquor houses. The closing two weeks of the campaign were filled with explicit airings of the purposes of the proposed amendment, and with the plans of the "legislative committee" who engineered the law through the houses at Salem.

And knowing this; being familiar with the whole silly frame-up; understanding all about the 24 quarts of beer and the two quarts of booze, the voters of Oregon cast a majority for the so-called "prohibition amendment." Oregon voted for the closing of the saloon and the brewery, and for the shipping in of a certain limited amount of liquor by those who wanted it. The people knew what they were going to get—and they got it.

This being the case, one must wonder why Mr. Brownell is breaking forth just as politics begin to ripen with this "attack" upon the prohibition law. People must wonder what George wants, what part this "opening shot" is to play in his own political plans, and what George himself is after?

The Courier prints Mr. Brownell's article because he was courteous enough to say that it might, and because it wants its readers to study it carefully. The complaint of Mr. Brownell is founded upon a faulty hypothesis at the start, so it amounts to nothing but two columns or so of words. But the purpose of it may be plain to some readers—and as this is the brewing time of 1916 politics, it is perhaps well to understand Mr. Brownell right at the start.

In brief: Oregon voters knew what they wanted and what they were voting for, both "drys" and "wets" buying much space in the newspapers to explain the workings of the amendment. The people voted for it. Presumably the people are happy in their choice. And, apparently, George C. Brownell is not happy. As a "prohibition" booster, as a man who has declared that he was going to run for U. S. senator on a prohibition platform, why shouldn't George C. Brownell like the law he supported during the campaign?

More Paving Planned
Paving of Third, Fourth, Fifth, Sixth, Eighth and Ninth streets, in the county seat, from the railroad tracks to the river, is planned by the city council. In the near future resolutions calling for this improvement work will be introduced.

Do you take the Courier? \$1.00 a year in advance.

"SAVING MONEY" FOR TAXPAYERS

WILLIAM E. STONE OUT WITH
SCHEME TO FATTEN POT
FOR FEE SEEKERS

WOULD AMEND CITY CHARTER

Attorney Wants Juries in Recorder's
Court and Elections for Choice
of Appointive Officers

Bursting in all the pristine glory of a young and rising politician into the limelight of newspaper publicity, William E. Stone, city attorney of the county seat when the municipal elevator stunt was "put over," this week confides in the Enterprise that he thinks the city charter ought to be amended in three ways.

Mr. Stone, who is a candidate for the republican nomination for prosecuting attorney in this county, and who studied law and politics under the able and experienced leadership of the Hon. George C. Brownell, thinks he can do a kindly duty for the common man and at the same time "save the taxpayers' money" by getting Oregon City's charter amended so that there may be jury trials in the recorder's court, and so that the recorder and city engineer will be elected to office by the people, instead of being given their jobs by the council.

Mr. Stone says that three amendments to the charter will be necessary to bring about these much needed reforms, and before the December municipal elections he will endeavor to have petitions signed with sufficient fervor to assure the proposed amendments going before the electorate.

Jury trials are not at present permitted in the recorder's court. The supreme court of Oregon has decided that they are not even necessary, as a jury is not needed—even though the constitution provides that any defendant may demand a trial "by a jury of his peers." However, adding jury trials to the work of the recorder's court would add a tremendous burden to the taxpayer. It would enlarge the system of fee-seeking, and would provide various and sundry "professional jurymen" with a wider range for the stalking and capturing of public funds. It would be possible to demand a jury for every trivial case, such as the charges of drunk and disorderly; and would make necessary the payment of a large sum annually in jury fees. Judging from the frequency with which juries are now demanded in the justice court, the passage of the proposed Stone amendment to the city charter would mean about three juries a week in the recorder's court—or an excess over present expenses of not less than \$800 a year. Probably the taxpayers would be glad to contribute this \$800 additional each year to enhance Mr. Stone's glory as a friend of the down-trodden and persecuted.

The amendments making the offices of city recorder and city engineer elective, instead of appointive, are also scintillating outbreaks of reform from a mind that refuses to be bound by precedent. The city recorder and city engineer are forced by their positions to work in constant harmony with the council. So that the council may have their aid all the time, it was deemed best by the original charter framers to allow the council to pick men who would be in sympathy with it. But Mr. Stone would throw the lists open, and would make it possible for a city engineer and city recorder to be elected that might or might not work well with the city dads.

To make the offices of city engineer and city recorder attractive to men of the right calibre, the salary would have to be raised. Men now accept these positions not so much for the salary they yield, but from a feeling of civic patriotism, that makes them willing to serve the city on a minimum pay. Possibly men of the same calibre would campaign for these offices under the Stone plan—but it is to be doubted. Probably the man who would make a fight for the office for the present salary would be the kind of a man who thought any salary at all was better than not having a finger in the municipal pork-barrel. If the salary is to be raised, again will the cheerful taxpayer be glad (presumably) to assist Mr. Stone's reform plans.

There is one excellent angle of the Stone idea, however. As a forecast of what may happen to Mr. Stone's ambition to be the republican standard-bearer in the coming county primaries, the charter amendment idea is hard to beat. If the people of the county seat endorse the proposed Stone amendment by their ballots, and add to the burden of taxpaying and to the intricacies of electioneering, then Mr. Stone may assume that he has a fighting chance to get the republican nomination that he covets. And if the people turn the Stone propaganda down—well, Mr. Stone

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